Premium Items, Half the Revenue: A Retail Product Performance Review

Nov 7, 2026 · @Natasha Chipyoka

Executive summary

Items priced above $30 earn about half the store's revenue, and a category's revenue rank follows its prices, not its sales volume. Between January 2022 and 18 January 2025 the store recorded $1.55M in sales from 25 customers. Items priced above $30 brought in 49% of revenue from 32% of transactions.

- **Price tier drives revenue.** Price barely changes how often an item sells (correlation 0.06), so each price tier earns in line with its prices. Within a tier, an item's revenue also depends on how often it sells. Items priced $5–$10 make up 14% of transactions but only 4% of revenue.
- **January is the peak.** January ran 10–24% above an average month in each of 2022, 2023 and 2024 (17% across the three years). Revenue then eases gently through the year.
- **Revenue is evenly spread.** Online and in-store split 51% and 49%, the three payment methods are close, and no customer accounts for more than 4.4% of revenue.

Recommendation: feature and protect the premium-priced items, plan the biggest promotions for January, and review the lowest-priced items.

Context, data and method

The analysis covers 12,575 retail transactions from 1 January 2022 to 18 January 2025, taken from a public Kaggle retail sales dataset. It spans 8 product categories (25 items each), 25 customers, and two channels, online and in-store. No rows were deleted.

- **Rebuilt:** 1,213 missing item names and 609 missing prices were recovered, because each item has one fixed price and each category has its own item code.
- **Excluded from revenue:** 604 transactions have neither quantity nor total, so revenue uses the other 11,971 ($1,552,071).
- **Labelled, not guessed:** the discount flag is blank on 4,199 transactions and is shown as Unknown.

Revenue is the sum of Total Spent. Averages are per transaction that has a total. Price bands are $5–$10, $11–$20, $21–$30 and above $30. Seasonality uses 2022–2024 only, because 2025 holds just 18 days.

What makes the money

Butchers earns the most ($208K, 13.4% of revenue) while selling the second-fewest units, because its items cost the most on average ($25.20 a unit).

Category	Revenue ($)	Share of revenue	Units sold	Avg price per unit ($)	Avg sale ($)
Butchers	208,118	13.4%	8,206	25.20	139.10
Electric household essentials	203,814	13.1%	8,309	24.50	134.40
Beverages	197,048	12.7%	8,358	23.30	131.70
Furniture	195,310	12.6%	8,462	23.30	128.10
Food	194,812	12.6%	8,387	23.20	129.30
Computers and electric accessories	190,693	12.3%	8,272	23.10	129.10
Patisserie	182,166	11.7%	7,943	23.00	126.40
Milk Products	180,112	11.6%	8,339	21.30	119.00

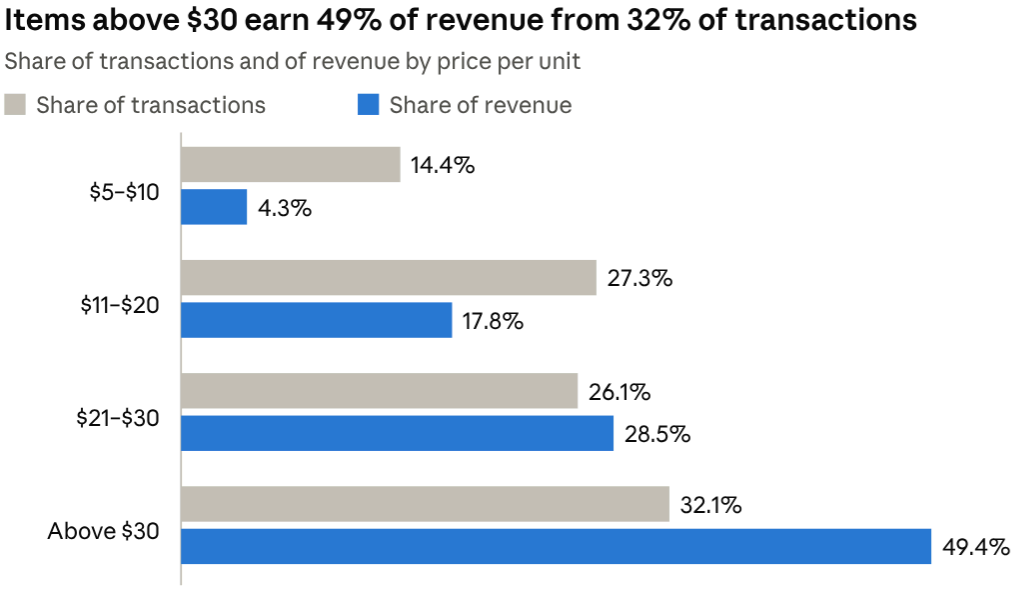
Categories rank for revenue in exactly the order of their average price per unit. Units sold sit within 3% of each other across seven categories (8,206 to 8,462), with Patisserie lowest at 7,943. Furniture sells the most units but ranks fourth for revenue, and Milk Products ranks last because its items are the cheapest.

The top 10 items bring in 14% of revenue and the top 20 bring in 26%, so no single item carries the business. The leaders combine a high price with high demand: the top 20 average $36.80 a unit and 99 transactions, against $23.00 and 60 across all 200 items.

Rank	Item	Price per unit ($)	Transactions	Revenue ($)
1	Item 25 (Furniture)	41.00	115	25,625
2	Item 25 (Electric household essentials)	41.00	108	25,502
3	Item 25 (Butchers)	41.00	100	22,427
4	Item 24 (Furniture)	39.50	109	22,081
5	Item 25 (Food)	41.00	96	21,771
6	Item 22 (Butchers)	36.50	108	21,462
7	Item 23 (Butchers)	38.00	102	20,596

Rank	Item	Price per unit ($)	Transactions	Revenue ($)
8	Item 19 (Milk Products)	32.00	115	20,448
9	Item 23 (Electric household essentials)	38.00	97	20,178
10	Item 23 (Patisserie)	38.00	93	19,684

Price tier is the clearest split. Items in every tier sell about equally often (54 to 65 transactions per item), so revenue follows price: items above $30 earn 49% of revenue from 32% of transactions.



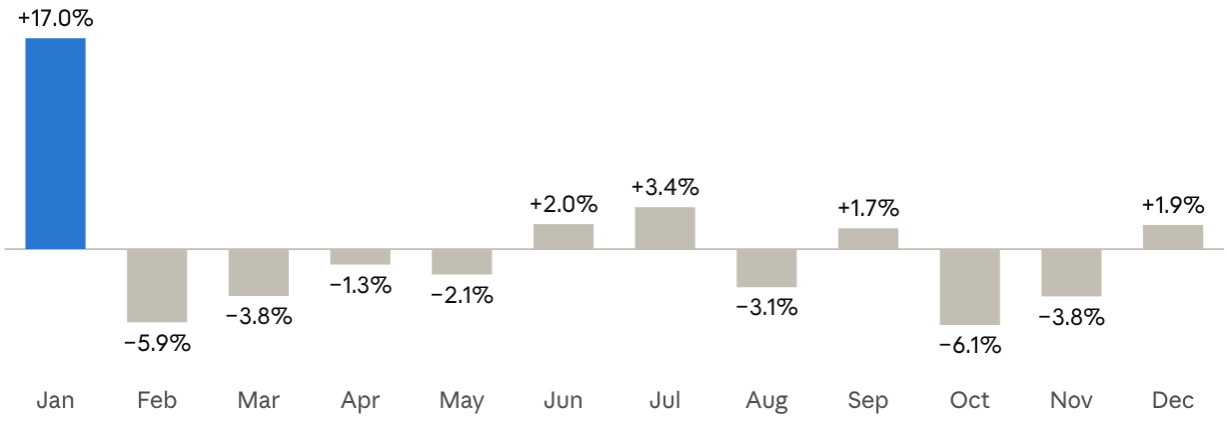
Retail store sales dataset · 11,971 transactions with a total · 1 Jan 2022 to 18 Jan 2025

When and how the money comes in

January is the strongest month, and the rest of the year is flat to gently declining. January ran 24% above the average month in 2022, 17% in 2023 and 10% in 2024, and February and October are the weakest months, each about 6% below average.

January runs 17% above the average month; no other month is more than 7% away

Revenue by calendar month vs the average month (0%), 2022 to 2024 combined



Retail store sales dataset · revenue by calendar month, 1 Jan 2022 to 31 Dec 2024 (2025 excluded: 18 days)

Quarterly revenue eases from $391K in Q1 to $371K in Q4, a 5% drop. Across full years, revenue was $510K in 2022, $491K in 2023 (down 3.7%) and $525K in 2024 (up 6.8%).

Channels and payment methods are balanced. Online brings in 51% of revenue ($791K) and in-store 49% ($761K), with an average sale of $130.40 online and $128.90 in-store, a gap too small to be meaningful. Cash accounts for 34.6% of revenue, and credit card and digital wallet 32.7% each.

Customer revenue is evenly spread. All 25 customers spend between $57K and $68K, and the largest accounts for 4.4% of the total, so the store does not depend on a few accounts.

Recommendations

Four actions follow from the findings, in order of expected impact.

1. **Feature and protect the premium items.** The 64 items priced above $30 are 32% of the range and earn 49% of revenue. Keep them in stock and give them the best placement.
2. **Plan the biggest promotions and stock for January.** It is the one month that stands out every year. Test promotions in February and October, the weakest months, to see whether they can be lifted.
3. **Review the cheapest items.** The 32 items priced $5–$10 make up 14% of transactions but 4% of revenue. Test bundling them with premium items, or review whether the range needs them. The data cannot show whether they bring in customers who then buy other things.

4. **Watch the Butchers category.** It is the top earner overall, yet its revenue fell 17% between 2022 ($79K) and 2024 ($66K), while Beverages grew 17%. Find out why before drawing conclusions.

Limitations and caveats

The findings describe this dataset and should not be read as proof of cause.

- **Price effects are untested.** Each item has one fixed price, so the data cannot show how demand would react to a price change. Run a controlled price test before changing prices.
- **Discounts cannot be assessed.** Total Spent always equals price times quantity, so the discount flag never changes spend. Average sale was $130.49 with a discount and $129.95 without, and the flag is blank on 4,199 transactions.
- **2025 is partial.** It holds 18 days (to 18 January 2025, $25.5K), so it is left out of year and month comparisons.
- **604 transactions have no total** and are excluded from revenue, so revenue figures are slightly understated.
- **Item names are anonymous** (for example Item 25 in Furniture), so recommendations refer to items by number and category.
- **Results are unusually even.** Channels, payment methods, customers and categories differ very little, which suggests the data may be synthetic. Treat the patterns as a worked example of the method, not as findings about a real business.